

You aren't gonna need it

"**You aren't gonna need it**"^{[1][2]} (**YAGNI**)^[3] is a principle which arose from extreme programming (XP) that states a programmer should not add functionality until deemed necessary.^[4] Other forms of the phrase include "You aren't going to need it"^{[5][6]} and "You ain't gonna need it".^[7]

Ron Jeffries, a co-founder of XP, explained the philosophy: "Always implement things when you actually need them, never when you just foresee that you [will] need them."^[8]

Context

YAGNI is a principle behind the XP practice of "do the simplest thing that could possibly work" (DTSTTCPW).^{[2][3]} It is meant to be used in combination with several other practices, such as continuous refactoring, continuous automated unit testing, and continuous integration. Used without continuous refactoring, it could lead to disorganized code and massive rework, known as technical debt. YAGNI's dependency on supporting practices is part of the original definition of XP.

See also



Engineering portal

- Don't repeat yourself (DRY)
- Feature creep
- If it ain't broke, don't fix it
- KISS principle – "Keep it simple, stupid"
- Minimum viable product
- MoSCoW method – development prioritization technique
- Muntzing – electronics minimalism
- Overengineering
- Single-responsibility principle (SRP)
- SOLID – Object-oriented programming design principles
- Unix philosophy – simple tools

References

1. Jeffries, Ronald E.; Anderson, Ann; Hendrickson, Chet (2001). *Extreme Programming Installed* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=l4zO3OWkdIsC&pg=PA190&dq=%22you+aren't+gonna+need+it%22&hl=en>). p. 190. "YAGNI: 'You Aren't Gonna Need It.' This slogan, one of XP's most famous..., reminds us always to work on the story we have, not something we think we're going to need."
2. Succi, Giancarlo; Marchesi, Michele (2001). *Extreme Programming examined* (https://books.google.com/books?id=VSChTNjn_O0C&q=%22you+aren't+gonna+need+it%22). "XP says 'do the simplest thing that could possibly work' because 'you aren't gonna need it'."
3. Schach, Stephen R. (2007). *Object-oriented & classical software engineering* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=hWwhAQAAIAAJ&q=%22you+aren't+gonna+need+it%22>). "Two acronyms now associated with extreme programming are YAGNI (you aren't gonna need it) and DTSTTCPW (do the simplest thing that could possibly work)."

4. Lindstrom, Lowell; Zannier, Carmen; Erdogmus, Hakan, eds. (2004). *Extreme Programming and Agile Methods – XP/Agile Universe 2004: 4th Conference on Extreme Programming and Agile Methods*. Lecture Notes in Computer Science. Berlin: Springer. p. 121. ISBN 3-540-22839-X.
5. Fowler, Martin; Beck, Kent (1999). *Refactoring: Improving the Design of Existing Code* (<http://books.google.com/books?id=1MsETFPD3I0C&pg=PA68>). Addison-Wesley Professional. p. 68. ISBN 978-0201485677. "you aren't going to need it."
6. Poppendieck, Mary; Poppendieck, Tom (2003). *Lean Software Development: An Agile Toolkit* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=hQk4S7asBi4C&pg=PA59>). p. 59. "Kent Beck, *Extreme Programming Explained*, Chapter 17, uses the acronym YAGNI (You Aren't Going to Need It) for this practice and explains its rationale."
7. Olsen, Russ (2007). *Design Patterns in Ruby*. p. 13. ISBN 9780321490452. "This design principle comes out of the Extreme Programming world and is elegantly summed up by the phrase You Ain't Gonna Need It (YAGNI for short)."
8. Jeffries, Ron (April 4, 1998). "You're NOT gonna need it!" (<http://ronjeffries.com/xprog/articles/practices/pracnotneed/>). Retrieved 2007-11-07.

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